

YEVHEN KVACH

SENIOR PHP BACKEND ENGINEER — SYMFONY · COMPLEX SYSTEMS · HIGH-LOAD

16 years of PHP in production · iGaming · payment & third-party integrations · AI-assisted engineering
Lviv, Ukraine (Remote, UTC+2/+3) · +380 (99) 269-57-67 · lemaxe@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/yeven-kvach ·
github.com/1emax

SUMMARY

- **Backend-focused PHP engineer (PHP 5 to 8.x):** Symfony, Laravel, Yii2; MySQL schema design and query tuning, Redis, async processing with RabbitMQ, Kafka and Gearman.
- **iGaming:** backend of a crypto-casino platform — evolved a Symfony monolith toward microservices and built a Kafka + ClickHouse pipeline for high-volume bet streams.
- **High-load:** systems serving ~1M daily visitors at 50–120 ms; cut AWS costs by \$15k/month by finding bottlenecks other senior engineers couldn't.
- **AI-assisted engineering, daily:** Claude Code and Codex in the delivery loop, repo-level agent instructions (AGENTS.md / CLAUDE.md) and specs; AI output reviewed to the same bar as human code. **Author and instructor of an AI-automation course.**

~1M daily visitors served at 50–120 ms	\$15k monthly AWS spend removed at MGID
60× faster page load at an ad-tech startup (30 s to 0.5 s)	25–80% faster ad player at MGID

INITIATIVE & PROBLEM SOLVING

I get handed the bottlenecks nobody else could locate — and then go looking for the next one without being asked. The \$15k/month AWS cut, the TypeScript migration and the Kafka + ClickHouse pipeline for bet streams all started as my own proposals. I measure before changing: profiler, query plans, real traffic.

TECH STACK

Backend: PHP 8.x · Symfony, Laravel, Yii2 (also CakePHP, Zend) · Doctrine ORM · REST APIs, WebSockets
Architecture: microservices, async / event-driven messaging, integration layers for third-party APIs
Data & messaging: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, Memcached, ClickHouse, Elasticsearch · RabbitMQ, Kafka, Gearman
Integrations: payments (WayForPay, LiqPay, Bitcoin) · ERP (1C/UkrSkklad) · CRM (Bitrix24, AmoCRM/Kommo) · OpenAI API
Quality: TDD / BDD: PHPUnit, Behat · OpenAPI contracts · code review, SOLID · profiling with Blackfire
Infra: Docker, docker-compose, CI/CD, Grafana, Nginx, Git
AI engineering: Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, Gemini, OpenCode · AGENTS.md / CLAUDE.md, specs · MCP servers, LLM agents, RAG, n8n
Also: Go (basic; open-source fixes), Node.js / TypeScript, Python

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer (contract) — iGaming & product companies (NDA) May 2024 – present
Long-term contract work for product teams under NDA; since 2025 also AI automation of business processes.

iGaming platform — crypto casino (PHP, Symfony)

- Delivered new features and performance work on the core Symfony platform; extracted services from the monolith into microservices; containerized the stack with Docker.

- Designed a Kafka + ClickHouse pipeline for high-volume bet streams: window-function analytics and custom data-retention logic.
- Worked test-first (TDD with PHPUnit, BDD with Behat); described service APIs as OpenAPI contracts.

Back-office / CRM backend (Laravel, Yii2, PostgreSQL)

- Built and supported CRM features and integrations for a media company.

AI automation & agents

- LLM projects in production: tool-using chatbots for two real-estate agencies, document-processing pipelines, voice-agent QA for sales calls (script-compliance scoring), Kommo CRM automation, a lightweight PHP ERP.
- AI-assisted delivery with Claude Code and Codex: maintain agent instruction files and specs so agents work predictably; keep payment, auth and personal-data logic under human ownership.
- Built MCP servers and agent tooling that give AI agents controlled access to internal systems.
- **Author and instructor of a course on AI automation** (n8n, LangChain, LLM agents).

Software Engineer — MGID (ad-tech, high-load)

Nov 2021 – Aug 2023

- On my own initiative profiled the Symfony backend and removed bottlenecks other senior engineers couldn't locate — **AWS costs down \$15k/month**.
- Ad player at ~1M daily visitors: 25–80% speed-up; proposed and led the TypeScript migration; integrated new ad partners.
- Shipped through CI/CD pipelines; tracked production performance and regressions in Grafana.

Tech Lead — Aviotto (Laravel)

Jul 2019 – Feb 2021

- Led the team: planning, code review, PDPs for developers; page load 60 s to 3 s (profiling, DB optimization, caching).
- In parallel (part-time): Tech Lead at Turbodealer (Yii2 + CodeIgniter), Jul 2019 – Feb 2020 — 10× faster page loads.

PHP Backend Developer — freelance & ad-tech startup (NDA)

Jan 2014 – Nov 2021

- Ad-tech startup: cut page load from 30 s to 0.5 s (60×) through profiling, DB optimization and caching.
- Took over a failing recommendation system at 50k DAU: refactoring, MySQL config/indexes/triggers, Memcached, moved writes to async Gearman workers and statistics to a separate DB server.
- Teaser ad network: fast, stable ad serving across a very wide range of clients; Memcached and query/schema optimization.
- Integration-heavy backends: e-commerce to UkrSklad ERP over Firebird with fuzzy (Levenshtein) record matching; websocket chat platform with PHP-Node.js events and token auth; configurable CRM with business-process designer.
- Open source (SONM, Go): tracked down and fixed bugs that blocked transaction settlement and task launch.

Earlier: Full-Stack Developer — WebImperia, FreshIT (2012–2013): online stores and CMS.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

NTU "KhPI", Faculty of Physics and Technology (2009–2015)

English — Upper-Intermediate (B2) · Ukrainian — native